

3.5 Storage on Mobile Handsets

New-age mobile phones are truly converged devices, and offer a host of features that would put a PC to shame. From basic contact management and organisers to gaming, imaging, music, video, e-mail, Internet connectivity - the latest mobile handsets



Various types of flash memory cards

have it all. Availability of all the above applications has made it necessary for cell phones to have high storage capacities. Even most high-end phones do not come with high storage capacities inbuilt, but they do provide the option to add more memory by using flash memory cards.

Flash memory is a form of rewritable memory chip that, unlike RAM, holds its content without the need of a power supply. It is a form of EEPROM (Electrically-Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory) that allows multiple memory locations to be erased or written in one programming operation - "in a flash"; This is where the name 'Flash' comes from. EEPROM is erased and written at the byte level whereas in the case of Flash memory, this operation is done in units of memory called blocks.

Flash memory is often used to hold control code such as in the BIOS in a PC. Flash memory offers fast read access times and significantly better shock resistance than hard drives. This makes it a popular choice for storage in a variety of mobile devices including mobile phones, PDAs, digital cameras, USB drives, and MP3 players. Since there are no moving parts in